

Sabre Corporation

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Travel Technology
Revenue	\$3B
Employees	8,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	92

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Sabre Corporation
Headquarters	Southlake, Texas
Founded	2000

Ownership

Public (NASDAQ: SABR); Constellation Software entered strategic governance agreement (2026); significant institutional ownership

Footprint

Global operations across 160+ countries; major offices in Southlake TX, Bangalore India, Krakow Poland, London UK, Singapore; offshore development centers expanding

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Sabre Corporation is a global travel technology company that powers booking, operations, and retailing for airlines, hotels, and travel agencies worldwide. Headquartered in Southlake, TX, Sabre is executing a once-in-a-generation platform rebuild from legacy GDS technology to an AI-native cloud architecture (Sabre Mosaic), accompanied by a \$65M restructuring, significant layoffs, C-suite reshuffle, and strategic governance agreement with Constellation Software.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Sabre Corporation's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

- Revenue: ~\$3B annual revenue; Q4 2025 beat expectations. Mid-single-digit revenue growth projected for 2026.
- Profitability: Pro forma adjusted EBITDA guidance of \$585M for 2026. Company transitioning from loss-making to sustainable profitability.
- Debt: Significant debt load from years of investment; Constellation Software governance agreement signals confidence in turnaround.
- Analyst Sentiment: Cautiously optimistic after Q4 beat. Stock surged on earnings. Key question: can the AI-native platform rebuild translate to revenue acceleration?
- Key Pressures: \$65M restructuring costs in 2026; technology debt from decades-old GDS infrastructure; competition from Amadeus and Travelport; airline direct distribution threatening GDS model.
- Key Tailwinds: AI/cloud transformation could create structural competitive advantage; travel industry recovery

post-COVID; new platform (Mosaic) generating airline interest; Constellation Software partnership.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Niklas Andréen - Chief Commercial Officer, Airline Tech [PRIORITY TARGET]

Appointed to accelerate airline adoption of Sabre Mosaic AI-native platform

Outreach rationale: Newly appointed to the most critical revenue-driving role during the platform transition. Must align sales, product, and engineering around the Mosaic platform while managing legacy customer relationships. Feels the organizational friction between old and new operating models daily.

Joe DiFonzo - Chief Information Officer [INFERRED] [PRIORITY TARGET]

Technology leadership during platform migration

Outreach rationale: Owns the technology transformation from legacy GDS to AI-native architecture - the highest-risk, highest-impact workstream. Must coordinate offshore engineering transition, legacy system decommissioning, and new platform delivery simultaneously.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Kurt Ekert - Chief Executive Officer

Former president of CWT (Carlson Wagonlit Travel); deep travel industry experience; leading the transformation

Jennifer Catto - Executive Vice President & Chief Marketing Officer

Marketing and brand leadership; responsible for repositioning Sabre as AI-native company

Scott Wilson - President, Hospitality Solutions

Leads hotel technology segment

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Sabre Corporation operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Reorganized around two major business lines: Airline Solutions (including the Mosaic platform rebuild) and Hospitality Solutions. Significant organizational disruption as workforce restructures around AI-native development, with traditional GDS roles being eliminated and new AI/cloud engineering roles created - many offshore.

Culture Signals

Identity Crisis: Sabre employees built careers on the legacy GDS platform that is now being described by

leadership as obsolete. The message 'we need a once-in-a-generation rebuild' implies the prior generation of work is being discarded - creating resistance and morale challenges.

Offshore Transition Anxiety: The \$65M restructuring includes relocating significant work to offshore development centers (primarily India). Onshore employees face job uncertainty while offshore teams must rapidly build capability in Sabre's complex domain.

Glassdoor Signals: [INFERRED] Likely mixed reviews reflecting restructuring anxiety, layoff uncertainty, but some optimism about the AI-native vision for those who remain.

Cultural Divide: A growing split between 'legacy Sabre' employees who understand the GDS business but resist change, and new hires brought in for the AI/cloud transformation who lack domain knowledge. Bridging this gap is essential for the platform rebuild to succeed.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Sabre Corporation.

1. 2026-03-03 - Unveiled multiyear AI-first unified cloud platform (Sabre Mosaic) at ITB Berlin

Publicly committed to the transformation - creates organizational urgency and customer expectations that must be met

2. 2026-02-19 - Announced \$65M restructuring with layoffs, offshore relocation, and C-suite reshuffle

Most disruptive organizational change in Sabre's history - creates immediate need for change management and cross-functional alignment

3. 2026-03-10 - Appointed Niklas Andréen as new CCO for Airline Tech

New commercial leadership for the most critical platform transition - must build relationships while legacy systems are being decommissioned

4. 2026-03-01 - Constellation Software entered strategic governance agreement with Sabre

New strategic partner adds governance complexity but signals external confidence in the transformation thesis

5. 2025-12-01 - Q4 2025 earnings beat expectations; stock surged; 2026 guidance set at mid-single-digit revenue growth

Financial momentum creates a window where transformation investments are justifiable to the board

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

CEO publicly declares need for transformation; \$65M restructuring creates acute organizational alignment need; new C-suite appointments signal openness to external support; revenue \$3B+ supports premium advisory spend; technology platform rebuild is a multi-year engagement opportunity; the 'build new while

maintaining old' challenge is exactly where McChrystal's operating model creates unique value vs. technology consultants.

Primary Problem

Executing a complete technology platform rebuild (legacy GDS -> AI-native cloud) while simultaneously restructuring the workforce, relocating capabilities offshore, and maintaining revenue from legacy systems that customers still depend on - a classic 'build the plane while flying it' challenge.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Organizational transformation and cross-functional alignment - Sabre needs to coordinate legacy system maintenance, new platform development, workforce restructuring, offshore transition, and customer migration in parallel. McChrystal's operating model ensures these workstreams reinforce rather than undermine each other.

Likely Objections to Engagement

We already have Accenture/Deloitte on the technology transformation
 Budget is constrained - \$65M restructuring costs absorb advisory capacity
 New C-suite is still getting established - may resist additional external voices
 Travel industry advisory is a specialized domain - does McChrystal understand it?

Competitive Advisory Landscape

Accenture - likely technology implementation partner for cloud/AI migration
 McKinsey - may advise on platform strategy and competitive positioning
 Deloitte - potential IT transformation and change management partner
 Oliver Wyman - travel industry specialist consultancy

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. As you rebuild the platform from legacy GDS to AI-native, how are you managing the tension between teams maintaining the legacy systems customers depend on and teams building the future?

Demonstrate understanding of the core organizational tension - two operating models running simultaneously.
 McChrystal's bridging methodology is the solution.

2. With the restructuring moving work offshore while simultaneously launching Sabre Mosaic, how are you ensuring the new distributed teams maintain the coordination speed the transformation demands?

Address the offshore transition challenge directly - distributed teams during transformation is a harder version of the problem McChrystal solved in military operations.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Position as a 20-minute conversation about what McChrystal has learned from organizations that successfully 'rebuilt the plane while flying it' - the parallel execution of legacy maintenance and new platform development. Emphasize that this is an operating model challenge, not a technology challenge.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Sabre Corporation's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Identity Evolution: Sabre is attempting to transform its brand from 'legacy GDS provider' to 'AI-native travel technology platform.' This is a fundamental repositioning - not a refresh. The appointment of a new CMO (Jennifer Catto) signals leadership's recognition that the brand must evolve alongside the technology.

Market Position: Sabre competes primarily with Amadeus (larger, European-based) and Travelport (smaller, PE-backed). In the GDS space, Sabre has lost market share over the past decade. The Mosaic platform is positioned as a leapfrog - bypassing incremental improvement for fundamental reinvention.

Brand Threats: Airlines increasingly building direct distribution capabilities (NDC standard) that bypass GDS entirely. If Sabre's AI-native platform doesn't offer compelling value beyond basic booking, the GDS model may become obsolete. This existential brand threat drives the urgency of the transformation.

McChrystal Connection: The brand transformation requires the technology transformation to deliver - a platform that doesn't work undermines the brand promise of 'AI-native.' This means marketing, product, engineering, and sales must be tightly coordinated. McChrystal's shared consciousness model ensures the brand promise and operational reality converge.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Sabre Corporation. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Dual Operating Model Coordination

Sabre must simultaneously run its legacy GDS platform (which generates current revenue) and build the AI-native Mosaic platform (which generates future revenue). These require fundamentally different organizational capabilities, cultures, and operating rhythms. McKinsey can recommend a 'dual operating model' - McChrystal builds the coordination architecture that prevents the two from cannibalizing each other. Competitor displacement: Accenture builds technology; McChrystal builds the organizational system that ensures technology gets built, adopted, and monetized.

Fit Dimension 2: Distributed Workforce Transformation

The offshore relocation creates a distributed workforce challenge at the worst possible moment - during a platform rebuild that requires intense collaboration. McChrystal's Team of Teams model was literally designed for this: enabling geographically distributed teams to operate with the coordination speed of a co-located startup. No strategy firm replicates this capability.

Fit Dimension 3: Change Absorption During Restructuring

8,000 employees facing layoffs, role changes, offshore relocation, and fundamental technology transformation simultaneously. McChrystal's organizational resilience frameworks prevent the predictable productivity collapse that accompanies this level of change.

9b. Cumulative Case - Why Sabre Is a Top Pipeline Opportunity

Sabre represents the highest-stakes technology transformation in the travel industry: a \$3B company bet its future on a complete platform rebuild while simultaneously restructuring its workforce, relocating capabilities offshore, and battling existential threats from airline direct distribution. The signal chain: Platform obsolescence -> CEO-driven transformation mandate -> \$65M restructuring -> C-suite reshuffle -> offshore relocation -> dual operating model required. Each step compounds the organizational coordination challenge.

Revenue Potential: \$350K-\$450K initial engagement (operating model design for dual platform coordination), expandable to \$1M-\$1.5M for enterprise-wide implementation, with \$300K-\$500K ongoing for transformation cadence management. Total: \$1.5M-\$2.5M over 18 months.

9c. Enterprise Issues & Organizational Challenges

1. Dual Operating Model Collision: Legacy GDS teams and AI-native Mosaic teams compete for resources, management attention, and organizational priority. Without explicit coordination, legacy maintenance degrades (risking current revenue) or new platform development slows (risking future viability).
2. Offshore Knowledge Transfer Gap: Decades of GDS domain knowledge resides in onshore employees being restructured out. Offshore teams must absorb this knowledge while simultaneously learning AI/cloud technologies - a double learning curve that typical offshore transitions don't face.
3. Customer Migration Uncertainty: Airlines and hotels currently on legacy systems must be convinced to migrate to Mosaic - but the platform isn't fully built yet. Sales teams must sell a vision while support teams maintain reality. Misalignment between these creates credibility risk.
4. Cultural Fragmentation: Three distinct cultures are colliding: legacy Sabre (domain experts, change-resistant), new AI/cloud hires (technologically advanced, domain-naive), and offshore teams (cost-efficient, relationship-distant). No unifying culture yet.
5. Constellation Software Governance Complexity: The new strategic governance agreement adds another decision-making layer during a period that demands speed. Balancing Constellation's governance requirements with transformation velocity is a new organizational challenge.
6. Competitive Clock: Amadeus is not standing still. Every month of delayed Mosaic delivery is a month where competitors can close the AI gap. Organizational friction directly translates to competitive disadvantage.

9d. Expected Outcomes from McChrystal Group Engagement

1. Dual Operating Model Architecture: Design coordination mechanisms between legacy and Mosaic teams that prevent resource competition and ensure both deliver. Measurable: zero unplanned legacy outages caused by resource diversion to Mosaic.
2. Distributed Team Operating Rhythm: Implement cross-timezone coordination cadence for onshore/offshore teams. Measurable: reduce decision-making latency for cross-team issues from days to hours.
3. Change Absorption Framework: Build organizational resilience system that maintains productivity through restructuring. Measurable: maintain platform development velocity within 10% of targets during restructuring period.
4. Customer Migration Coordination: Align sales, product, engineering, and support around customer migration sequencing. Measurable: achieve 90%+ on-time customer migration milestone completion.
5. Cultural Integration Program: Create shared identity and operating norms across legacy, new hire, and offshore populations. Measurable: reduce cross-team escalations by 50% within 6 months.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

Airline Solutions

Leader: Niklas Andréen, CCO

Function: Commercial leadership for airline tech including Mosaic

McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Dual operating model challenge - legacy + Mosaic

Hospitality Solutions

Leader: Scott Wilson [INFERRED], President

Function: Hotel technology segment

McChrystal Relevance: Important: must coordinate with airline tech transformation

Technology / CIO

Leader: Joe DiFonzo [INFERRED], CIO

Function: Platform rebuild, IT infrastructure, offshore engineering

McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Technical transformation execution

Marketing

Leader: Jennifer Catto, EVP & CMO

Function: Brand repositioning from GDS to AI-native

McChrystal Relevance: Brand-technology alignment

Office of the CEO

Leader: Kurt Ekert, CEO

Function: Enterprise transformation mandate, Constellation governance

McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

Human Resources

Leader: [TBD], CHRO

Function: Workforce restructuring, offshore transition, culture

McChrystal Relevance: Critical: change management and retention

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now: Platform obsolescence -> CEO transformation mandate -> \$65M restructuring (Feb 2026) -> C-suite reshuffle -> Mosaic platform launch (Mar 2026) -> Constellation governance agreement. The convergence of technology, organizational, and governance transformation in a 6-month window creates maximum organizational complexity - and maximum receptivity to external operating model expertise.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: Accenture builds the Mosaic platform. McKinsey advises on competitive strategy. Oliver Wyman provides travel industry expertise. But none of them build the operating model that coordinates a dual-platform organization, manages distributed workforce transformation, and maintains customer confidence during migration. McChrystal fills the gap between technology delivery and organizational execution.

Phased Engagement Hypothesis - Land and Expand:

- Phase 1 (Months 1-3, \$350K-\$450K): Dual Operating Model Design - map coordination gaps between legacy and Mosaic teams, design operating rhythm for offshore/onshore collaboration, and pilot with one airline customer migration. Beachhead: airline customer migration coordination - visible, measurable, and directly tied to revenue.
- Phase 2 (Months 4-9, \$700K-\$1M): Enterprise-wide deployment across all business units. Integration of restructuring, offshore transition, and platform development into unified cadence.
- Phase 3 (Months 10-18, \$300K-\$500K retainer): Ongoing transformation management, cultural integration, Constellation governance coordination.

Competitive Displacement Strategy: Position as the firm that makes Accenture's technology investment and McKinsey's strategy actually execute. Frame: "The platform rebuild is on track technically - McChrystal ensures the organization can absorb and monetize it." Avoid competing on technology or strategy; own the organizational execution layer.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit Map:

- Thread 1: Niklas Andréen (new CCO) - dual operating model challenge. Angle: "How are you coordinating legacy customer maintenance with Mosaic migration?" He's new enough to be open to external support.
- Thread 2: CHRO/Head of People - workforce transformation. Angle: "How is the offshore transition affecting coordination speed during the platform rebuild?" HR leaders often champion organizational effectiveness engagements.
- Thread 3: Kurt Ekert (CEO) via board connection or conference proximity - executive sponsor angle. Ekert publicly acknowledges the transformation need; a warm introduction through travel industry networks or McChrystal's military connections could open the door.